

APRIL 2026 COMMON MONTHLY ASSESSMENT

GLOBAL HISTORY AND GEOGRAPHY

Student Name _____

Date _____

The possession or use of any communications device is strictly prohibited when taking this examination. If you have or use any communications device, no matter how briefly, your examination will be invalidated and no score will be calculated for you.

Print your name and the date on the lines above. A separate answer sheet has been provided to you.

This examination has two parts. You are to answer all questions in **all** parts.

Part I contains 17 multiple-choice questions. Record your answers to these questions as directed on the answer sheet.

Part II contains one set of constructed-response questions (CRQ). The constructed response question set is made up of two documents accompanied by several questions.

Base your answers to question 1 on the passage below and on your knowledge of social studies.

...India, in the eighteenth century, was an empire ready to be conquered. This vast continent, so rich in resources of every kind, was divided into many states, colonized on the edges, and constantly rent [torn] by war. By the 1730s, the Mogul [Mughal] Empire, which had once ruled two-thirds of its land area, had collapsed; new states had arisen in great numbers; older states, once subordinated to the empire, had recovered their full independence. And then there were the foreigners.

Some, like the Portuguese in Goa, really did not matter: they controlled a port and its immediate hinterland [back country] in order to trade – in spices, rice, ivory, precious stones, rare tropical woods, and silk – and that was the limit of their ambition. Others, like the French, had once hoped to have an empire in India, but Great Britain had defeated them during the Seven Years' War (1756-1763), and they had been left with a mere five ports. There remained the British, or rather that oddest of entities, the East India Company...

Source: Olivier Bernier, *The World in 1800*, John Wiley & Sons, 2000

- 1 What impact did the situation described in this passage have on Mughal rule?
- (1) Mughal political and economic authority became more centralized.
 - (2) Foreign influence in India led to the Mughals' loss of territorial control.
 - (3) The Mughals led successful resistance efforts against French interference.
 - (4) Competition between European countries brought increased stability to the Mughals.

Base your answers to questions 2 and 3 on the excerpt below and on your knowledge of social studies.

9. As all persons are held innocent until they shall have been declared guilty, if arrest shall be deemed indispensable, all harshness not essential to the securing of the prisoner's person shall be severely repressed by law.
10. No one shall be disquieted [oppressed] on account of his opinions, including his religious views, provided their manifestation [display] does not disturb the public order established by law.
11. The free communication of ideas and opinions is one of the most precious of the rights of man. Every citizen may, accordingly, speak, write, and print with freedom, but shall be responsible for such abuses of this freedom as shall be defined by law....

Source: Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen, 1789

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| <p>2 Which group would be most likely to support the ideas presented in this document?</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none">(1) the nobility(2) the clergy(3) the Third Estate(4) the royal officials | <p>3 Which claim is best supported by this document?</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none">(1) People arrested should be presumed guilty until proven innocent.(2) The rights of all citizens should be respected with fairness and justice.(3) Religious practices should be limited by the government.(4) Freedom of speech should be restricted for the public good. |
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Base your answers to questions 4 and 5 on the map below and on your knowledge of social studies.

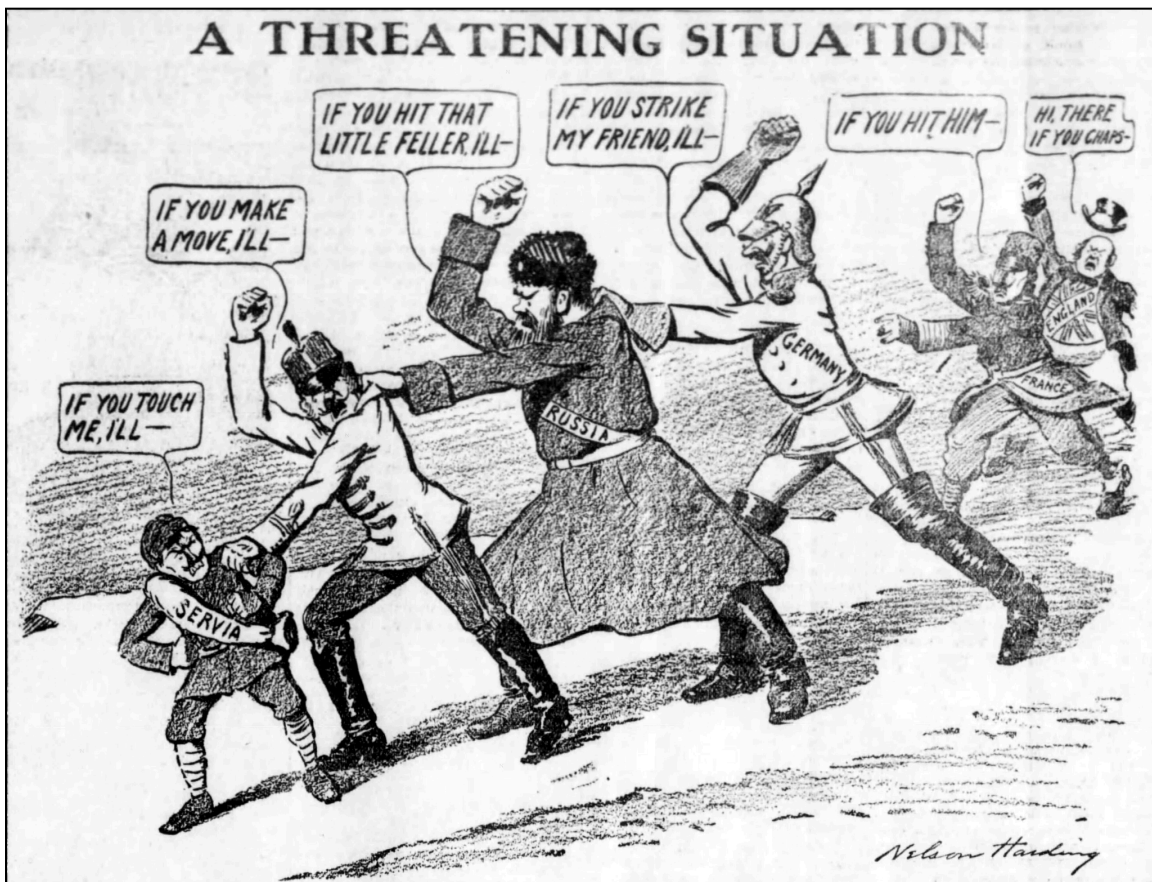


Source: Beers, *World History: Patterns of Civilization*, 1983 (adapted)

- 4 An abundance of coal, an irregular coastline and a large labor force are all reasons as to why
- (1) Great Britain experienced political turmoil
 - (2) Great Britain sought colonies abroad
 - (3) Great Britain was the birthplace of the Industrial Revolution
 - (4) Great Britain became involved in World War I

- 5 Cities like Manchester, Leeds and Birmingham developed into large population centers due to their
- (1) Proximity to coal and iron mines
 - (2) Locations along the coast
 - (3) Social welfare programs
 - (4) High quality of life

Base your answers to questions 6 and 7 on the cartoon below and on your knowledge of social studies.



Source: Nelson Harding, "A Threatening Situation," Brooklyn Eagle, December 4, 1912

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| <p>6 Which event occurred as a result of the situation illustrated in this cartoon?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) the sinking of unarmed ships by France(2) the installation of the Weimar government(3) the rejection of the Treaty of Versailles(4) the assassination of the archduke of Austria | <p>7 Based on this cartoon, which statement best describes the cartoonist's point of view?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) European militarism prevented conflict.(2) European peace relied on collective security.(3) A system of European alliances caused the escalation of tension in Europe.(4) Serbia was able to avoid getting involved with other European countries. |
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Base your answers to questions 8 and 9 on the letter below and on your knowledge of social studies.

Siegfried Sassoon, a British soldier, sent the following letter to his commanding officer and refused to return to the trenches. The letter was eventually read in the House of Commons and was published in local newspapers and *The Times of London*.

...At times, gas has been known to travel, with dire results, fifteen miles behind the lines.

A gas, or smoke helmet, as it is called, at the best is a vile-smelling thing, and it is not long before one gets a violent headache from wearing it.

Our eighteen-pounders were bursting in No Man's Land, in an effort, by the artillery, to disperse the gas clouds.

The fire step was lined with crouching men, bayonets fixed, and bombs near at hand to repel the expected attack.

Our artillery had put a barrage of curtain fire on the German lines, to try and break up their attack and keep back re-inforcements.

I trained my machine gun on their trench and its bullets were raking the parapet [spraying the wall].

Then over they came, bayonets glistening. In their respirators, which have a large snout in front, they looked like some horrible nightmare...

Source: Arthur Empey, "Over the Top," G. P. Putnam's Sons, 1917

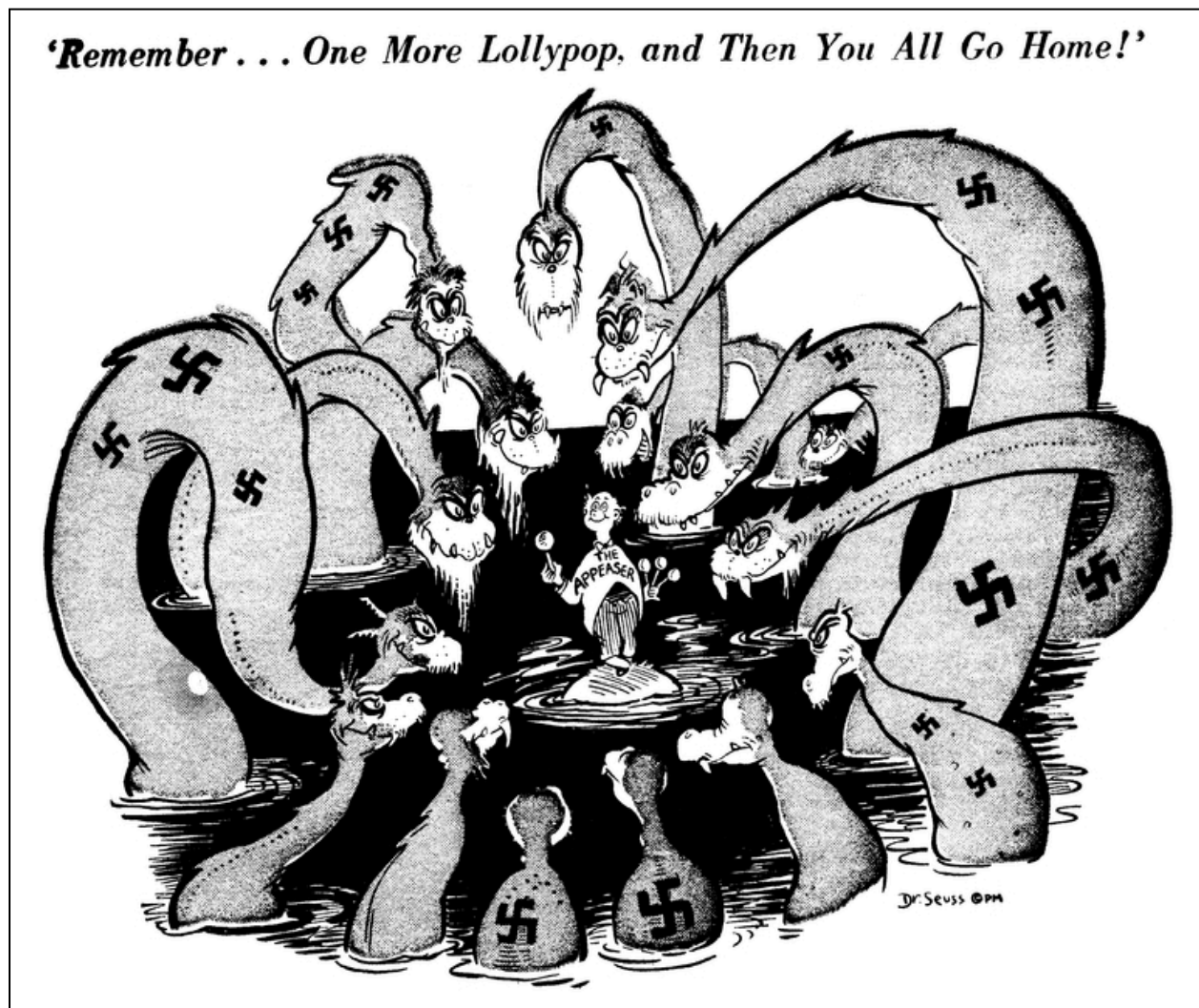
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| <p>8 A historian could best use this passage to study which topic of World War I?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) events that started the war(2) impact of combat on civilians(3) equipment utilized by soldiers(4) propaganda that supported the war effort | <p>9 Which claim can best be supported by this passage?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) New technology made warfare more destructive.(2) Warfare had a limited impact on the environment.(3) Countries engaged in war were punished for their actions.(4) Illness and disease took many lives. |
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Base your answers to questions 10 and 11 on the headlines below and on your knowledge of social studies.

"Stalin Solidifies Power for Communists"
"Adolf Hitler Declares Third Reich"
"Mussolini Establishes Fascist State"

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| <p>10 Which situation was most responsible for the rise of the political systems referred to in these headlines?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) unification of Italy(2) conflicts between European nations over Africa(3) worldwide economic instability(4) emergence of the United States as a world power | <p>11 What is a common characteristic of the political systems represented in these headlines?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) multinationalism(2) capitalism(3) humanitarianism(4) totalitarianism |
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Base your answers to questions 12 and 13 on the cartoon below and on your knowledge of social studies.



Source: Dr. Seuss, *PM*

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| <p>12 What led most directly to the situation depicted in this cartoon?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) the reluctance of Europeans to get drawn into another war(2) international support for German militarism(3) the success of European peacemaking(4) the Allies' demand for German war reparations | <p>13 What was an immediate effect of the actions depicted in this cartoon?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(1) The United States entered World War II.(2) The Nazis proceeded to take over new territory.(3) Wilson's Fourteen Points allowed Germany to rebuild its military.(4) Nazi leaders were tried for crimes against humanity at Nuremberg. |
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Base your answers to questions 14 and 15 on the passage below and on your knowledge of social studies.

...Then a tremendous flash of light cut across the sky. Mr. Tanimoto has a distinct recollection that it travelled from east to west, from the city toward the hills. It seemed a sheet of sun. Both he and Mr. Matsuo reacted in terror—and both had time to react (for they were 3,500 yards, or two miles, from the center of the explosion). Mr. Matsuo dashed up the front steps into the house and dived among the bedrolls and buried himself there. Mr. Tanimoto took four or five steps and threw himself between two big rocks in the garden. He belled up very hard against one of them. As his face was against the stone, he did not see what happened. He felt a sudden pressure, and then splinters and pieces of boards and fragments of tile fell on him. He heard no roar. (Almost no one in Hiroshima recalls hearing any noise of the bomb. But a fisherman in his sampan [boat] on the Inland Sea near Tsuzu, the man with whom Mr. Tanimoto's mother-in-law and sister-in-law were living, saw the flash and heard a tremendous explosion, he was nearly twenty miles from Hiroshima, but the thunder was greater than when the B-29s hit Iwakuni, only five miles away)...

Source: John Hersey, *Hiroshima*, Alfred A. Knopf, 1946

14 How could a historian best use this passage?

- (1) to understand how the atomic bomb affected civilians
- (2) to investigate why the military dropped the atomic bomb
- (3) to illustrate how the war effort was affected by the atomic bomb
- (4) to show how the atomic bomb changed government policy

15 The events described in the passage led to the

- (1) creation of spheres of influence in China
- (2) D-Day invasion of Normandy
- (3) Japanese surrender in World War II
- (4) collapse of the Soviet Union

Base your answers to question 16 on the passage below and on your knowledge of social studies.

**Address Given by President Harry Truman to a Joint Session of Congress
on March 12, 1947**

At the present moment in world history nearly every nation must choose between alternative ways of life. The choice is too often not a free one. . . .

I believe that it must be the policy of the United States to support free peoples who are resisting attempted subjugation [oppression] by armed minorities or by outside pressures.

I believe that we must assist free peoples to work out their own destinies in their own way. . .

Source: President Harry S. Truman, Address to Congress

16 Which historical development is most closely associated with the situation described in this passage?

- (1) Berlin Conference
- (2) Armenian Massacre
- (3) Nuremberg Trials
- (4) Cold War

Base your answers to question 17 on the passage below and on your knowledge of social studies.

In June 1948, objecting to West Germany's decision to introduce a reformed Deutsche Mark currency to West Berlin, the Soviets cut off the corridor [route] at ground level. More broadly, it is believed, they hoped to make maintaining the connection with Germany's former capital such a headache that the West would think better of the whole thing and let the idea slide. On the contrary, though: the British and Americans inaugurated a massive airlift, flying supplies into the city – everything from food and vital technology to coal. An overblown response, maybe, but it made the Soviet blockade look petty, pointless – and, worst of all in the circumstances, unavailing [unsuccessful].

Source: Michael Kerrigan, *Stalin*, Amber Books, 2018

17 According to this author, the purpose of the Berlin Airlift was to

- (1) instill fear amongst the people of Berlin
 - (2) provide necessary resources to West Berliners
 - (3) evacuate the citizens from West Berlin
 - (4) prove that the Berlin blockade was effective
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Name: _____ Date: _____

Write your answers to questions 18–20b in the spaces provided. Use a pen with black or dark-blue ink to answer these questions.

Part II

SHORT-ANSWER CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE QUESTIONS (CRQ)

These questions are based on the accompanying documents and are designed to test your ability to work with historical documents. Each Constructed Response Question (CRQ) Set is made up of 2 documents. Some of these documents have been edited for the purposes of this question. Keep in mind that the language and images used in a document may reflect the historical context of the time in which it was created.

In developing your answers to Part II, be sure to keep these explanations in mind:

Identify—means to put a name to or to name.

Explain—means to make plain or understandable; to give reasons for or causes of; to show the logical development or relationship of something.

Short-Answer CRQ Set Structure

- Question 18 uses Document 1 (Context)
- Question 19 uses Document 2 (Source)
- Question 20a and 20b use Documents 1 and 2 (Relationship between documents)

CRQ Set 1 Directions (18–20b): Analyze the documents and answer the short-answer questions that follow each document in the space provided.

Base your answer to question 18 on Document 1 below and on your knowledge of social studies.

Document 1

...Despite the turmoil, the authorities could have contained the situation if they had avoided open conflict with the crowds. But the forces of the tsar [czar] opened fire, killing protesters. The demonstrations began to turn into a full-scale revolution as angry protesters broke into the barracks of the city’s Pavlovsky Regiment. Rather than attack them, the soldiers joined the protesters, some even firing on their own officers... Nothing less than Tsar Nicholas’s abdication [resignation], meanwhile, could save the war campaign against Germany—all his senior generals told him so. The Duma also called on him to stand down. On March 2, 1917, Nicholas II gave up the throne. The end of the monarchy was marked by scenes of rejoicing throughout the Russian Empire. Symbols of monarchical power—emblems, coats of arms, double-headed eagles, and tsarist statues— were destroyed.

Source: Orlando Figes, *History Magazine*, National Geographic, October 25, 2017

18 Explain the historical circumstances that led to the abdication of Tsar Nicholas II. [1]

Score

Base your answer to question 19 on Document 2 below and on your knowledge of social studies.

Document 2

On June 23, 1931, Joseph Stalin delivered a speech, “New Conditions — New Tasks in Economic Construction,” at a Conference of Business Executives. It was attended by representatives of the economic organizations united under the Supreme Council of the National Economy of the U.S.S.R. [Soviet Union] and by the People’s Commissariat of Supply of the U.S.S.R. The speech was published in the Soviet newspaper Pravda on July 5, 1931.

...As you see, we now have an entirely new situation and new conditions in regard to the supply of manpower for our factories.

What follows from that?

It follows, firstly, that we must no longer count on an automatic influx [increase] of manpower. This means that we must pass from the “policy” of letting things proceed automatically to the policy of organized recruiting of workers for industry. But there is only one way of achieving this—that of contracts of economic organizations with collective farms and collective farmers. As you know, certain economic organizations and collective farms have already adopted this method; and experience has shown that this practice yields important advantages both for the collective farms and for the industrial enterprises.

It follows, secondly, that we must pass immediately to mechanization of the heavier processes of labour and develop this to the utmost (timber industry, building industry, coal mining, loading and unloading, transport, iron and steel industry, etc.). This, of course, does not mean that we must abandon manual labour. On the contrary, manual labour will continue to play a very important part in production for a long time to come. But it does mean that mechanization of labour processes is for us the new and decisive force, without which neither our tempo nor the new scale of production can be maintained. . . .

Source: Speech by Joseph Stalin, 1931

19 Based on this excerpt, identify Stalin’s point of view regarding the Soviet economy. [1]

Score

Base your answer to question 20 on *both* Documents 1 and 2 and on your knowledge of social studies.

Turning point—is a major event, idea, or historical development that brings about significant change. It can be local, regional, national, or global.

20 Using evidence from both Documents 1 and 2 and your knowledge of social studies:

- a) Identify a turning point directly associated with the historical developments found in both Documents 1 and 2. [1]
- b) Explain how the turning point you identified created significant change using evidence from both Documents 1 and 2. [1]

20a Score

20b Score